



BEST FOREIGN
BANK & BEST IN
INNOVATION—
FOREIGN BANK
HSBC INDIA

business of bidding for assets.

The second reason is the bank's capabilities in structured trade. "What we can do in structured trade, I do not think anyone else comes close to us," says Dave. Structured trade has many advantages for banks in terms of capital

treatment. Even corporates have an option to keep it off the balance sheet.

Third, over the last three years, the bank's retail loan portfolio—including mortgages, cards and other assets—has grown at close to 20%.

Hitendra Dave, CEO,
HSBC India

That consistency is probably why HSBC India has emerged a winner in two categories—the Best Foreign Bank as well as the jury winner for Best Innovation in the foreign banking space.

What is important is that this sustained growth has been anchored in a highly secured balance sheet. Per the *BT-KPMG* study, secured advances account for 66.43% of the loan book—the highest among peers—compared with around 56% for Deutsche Bank, which is ranked 2nd, and 55% for Standard Chartered, which is ranked 7th in the survey.

The bank recently received RBI's licence for 20 more branches in cities like Bhopal, Jalandhar, Dehradun, Nashik and Vadodara, which will expand its presence from 14 to 34 cities. This will make it the second-largest foreign bank in India by branch network after Standard Chartered.

HSBC is probably the first foreign bank, after almost two to three decades, to pursue expansion at this scale. "We have already opened four branches," says Dave. Branch expansion blends local presence with global capabilities to tap emerging wealth centres and connect Indian clients to global opportunities.

The selection of cities was based on three primary criteria—level of wealth, size of NRI population, and the city's role as a manufacturing hub so that the bank can support trade. "The decision reflects a clear shift in the geography of wealth in India over the past decade.